

General Sports Rules & Regulations

1. All sports competitions shall be organized and conducted by the Sports Department, Darshan University.
2. Rules for each sport shall be governed by the standard rules of the respective national and/or international sports federations, unless specifically modified and notified by the Sports Department for tournament purposes.
3. Any sport-specific rules, match formats, scoring systems, or adaptations mentioned in the Sports Handbook or communicated separately shall be treated as tournament-specific regulations and shall prevail in case of any inconsistency with standard rules.
4. The decision of the referee, umpire, judge, or match official appointed by the Sports Department shall be final and binding on all participants.
5. Participants are expected to maintain discipline, sportsmanship, and fair play at all times. Any form of misconduct, argument with officials, or unsportsmanlike behavior may result in warning, penalty, or immediate disqualification.
6. All teams/players must report at the venue well before the scheduled match time, as notified by the Sports Department. Failure to report on time may result in a walkover being awarded to the opponent.
7. The Sports Department reserves the right to:
 - Modify match schedules, formats, or venues
 - Amend rules in the interest of safety and fair competition
 - Cancel or reschedule matches due to unavoidable circumstances
8. Safety of participants shall be of highest priority. Players must strictly follow all safety instructions issued by officials. Violation of safety norms may lead to immediate disqualification.
9. The use of unfair means, prohibited equipment, or false representation shall not be permitted and may lead to disciplinary action.
10. Any situation not explicitly covered under these rules shall be resolved by the Sports Department, Darshan University, whose decision shall be final.
11. These general rules shall apply to all indoor and outdoor sports including individual and team events.

1. Badminton

✓ **Scoring System:**

- ❖ Rally Point Scoring System shall be followed.
- ❖ A point shall be scored on every rally, irrespective of service.
- ❖ The side winning a game shall serve first in the subsequent game.

✓ **Service Rules:**

- ❖ At the start of the game (0-0) and whenever the server's score is even, the serve shall be delivered from the right service court.
- ❖ When the server's score is odd, the serve shall be delivered from the left service court.
- ❖ If the server wins a rally, a point is scored and the server continues, alternating the service court.
- ❖ If the receiver wins a rally, the receiver becomes the new server.

✓ **Match Duration:**

- ❖ Semi-Final & Final matches: Up to 21 points.
- ❖ Other knockout matches: Up to 15 points.

2. Cricket (Tennis)

✓ **General Playing Rules:**

- ❖ The umpire's decision on the field shall be final.
- ❖ A maximum of five fielders are permitted on the leg side, including the bowler.
- ❖ Bye, leg-bye, wide, and no-ball runs shall be counted.
- ❖ All no-balls shall result in a free hit.
- ❖ A maximum of two bouncers is allowed per over.
- ❖ Close wicket keeping is permitted only after informing the leg umpire.
- ❖ Injured players shall not be allowed a runner and may only retire hurt.
- ❖ Maximum interval between innings shall be 10 minutes.

✓ **Match Format:**

- ❖ Semi-Final & Final: 10 overs per side (2 power plays).
- ❖ Other matches: 8 overs per side (2 power plays).

✓ **Bowling Restrictions:**

- ❖ 8-over match: Maximum 2 overs per bowler.
- ❖ 10-over match: Maximum 3 overs per bowler.

✓ **Fielding Restrictions:**

- ❖ During restriction overs, a maximum of two fielders are allowed outside the 30-yard circle.

3. Cricket (Season)

✓ **General Rules for Cricket Tournament:**

- ❖ On-field, the Umpire's decision is final. Any argument against the umpire may lead to disqualification of the team.
- ❖ Maximum 5 fielders on the leg side, including the bowler's end.
- ❖ Extra runs such as bye, leg bye, wide, and no-ball will be counted.
- ❖ All no-balls will result in a free hit.
- ❖ A maximum of 2 bouncers per over is allowed.
- ❖ For close wicket-keeping, the keeper must inform the leg umpire beforehand.

- ❖ An injured player is not allowed a runner. Such a player will be considered retired hurt.
 - ❖ The maximum break between innings is 10 minutes.
- ✓ **Rules for Overs & timing:**

Match Type	Overs	Time Limit
Semi-Final	12	40 min
Final	14	50 min

- ✓ **Rules for Fielding & Bowling:**
- ❖ Maximum 3 overs per bowler in a 12-over match.
 - ❖ Maximum 4 overs per bowler in a 14-over match.
 - ❖ Maximum 2 players outside the 30-yard circle during fielding restrictions:
 - Semi-final: 4 overs
 - Final: 5 overs
 - ❖ A 5-minute delay from the fielding side will result in one over being deducted for that side.

4. Box Cricket

- ✓ **General Rules for Box Cricket Tournament:**
- ❖ **Team Size:** Each team consists of 8 players.
 - ❖ **Match Duration:** The match is played with 6 overs per side.
 - ❖ During the declared Power Play overs, if the ball goes out of the box from both sides of the net (clears the boundary), it counts as 6 Runs.
 - ❖ During Power Play overs, a maximum of 1 fielder is allowed on the boundary line.
 - ❖ A ball hitting the side or back net directly results in the batsman being out.
 - ❖ There is no Leg Before Wicket dismissal in this format.
- ✓ **Bowling Regulations:**
- ❖ **Bowling Style:** Deliveries must be underarm or medium pace only. Fast bowling is strictly prohibited.
 - ❖ **Speed Limit:** Maximum bowling speed allowed is 70 km/h.
 - ❖ Any delivery exceeding 70 km/h will be declared a No-Ball.
 - ❖ **Over Limits:** One bowler cannot bowl consecutive overs.
 - ❖ **Extras:** Standard Wide and No-Ball rules apply (usually 1 run + extra ball).

5. Kho-Kho

- ✓ **General Rules for Kho-Kho Tournament:**
- ❖ **Minimum Participation:** The tournament will only proceed if there are more than 4 teams registered.
 - ❖ **Squad Size:** Each team consists of 12 players in total.
 - Only 9 players take the field for a contest (9 Chasers).
 - The remaining 3 are substitutes.
 - ❖ A match consists of two innings.
 - ❖ Each innings consists of distinct Chasing and Defending turns.
 - ❖ Each turn lasts for 9 minutes.

- ❖ 8 players from the chasing team sit or kneel in the middle of the court in a row (the Central Lane).
- ❖ Alignment: Adjacent members must face opposite directions
- ❖ The Active Chaser: Starts at the pole or entry zone to begin the chase.
- ❖ The active chaser can only run in one direction (the direction they are facing upon starting or receiving a Kho).
- ❖ The active chaser cannot cut across the central line (between the sitters). They must run around the poles at the end of the row to reach the other side of the court.
- ❖ To change the active chaser, the current chaser must touch a sitting teammate on the back.
- ❖ The chaser must shout "KHO" loudly and clearly to signify the change of guard.
- ❖ The sitter receiving the "Kho" becomes the new active chaser and takes over the pursuit.
- ❖ Unlike chasers, the Dodgers can run in any direction (randomly).
- ❖ Dodgers are allowed to run in between the sitters to evade the chaser.
- ❖ Avoid being tagged by the active chaser for the duration of the turn.
- ❖ The Chasers must tag all opponents (Dodgers) in the field.
- ❖ The team that takes the shortest time to tag all opponents wins the match.

6. Kabaddi

✓ General Rules for Kabaddi Tournament:

- ❖ The tournament for this sport will only be conducted if there are more than 4 teams (or groups of players) registered.
- ❖ Each team must have 7 players on the court at the start of play.
- ❖ Teams are permitted to have a bench of 3 to 5 substitutes.
- ❖ The match is divided into two halves with a halftime break.
 - **First Half:** 10 Minutes
 - **Break:** 5 Minutes
 - **Second Half:** 10 Minutes
 - *Total Match Time: 25 Minutes*
- ❖ Each team is allowed **1 Timeout** per half.
- ❖ All other gameplay mechanics (Raiding, Defending, Bonus Lines, Lobbies, Scoring) will follow the official rules set by the AKFI (Amateur Kabaddi Federation of India).

7. Table Tennis

✓ Match Format & Scoring

- ❖ **Winning a Game:** A game is won by the player who first scores 11 points.
- ❖ The 2-Point Lead Rule: The winner must lead by at least 2 points.
- ❖ Example: If the score reaches 10–10 (Deuce), play continues until one player establishes a 2-point lead (e.g., 12–10, 13–11).
- ❖ **Match Duration:** The match is played as a Best of 3 Games (the first player to win 2 games wins the match).

✓ The Toss & Choice

- ❖ The choice of playing position and order of service is decided by a coin toss.
- ❖ The winner of the toss may choose either:

- ❖ To serve or receive first; **OR** To start at a particular end (side) of the table.
- ❖ The loser of the toss takes the remaining choice.
- ✓ **Service Regulations**
 - ❖ Service changes hands after every 2 points.
 - ❖ Exception (Deuce): At 10–10, the service changes after every 1 point.
 - ❖ A service is considered legal ("Good Service") only if:
 - The ball rests freely on the open palm of the server's stationary free hand.
 - The ball is tossed vertically upward from above the table surface (not from below).
 - Both the ball and the racket must be behind the server's end line.
 - The ball must touch the server's side first, pass over the net, and then touch the receiver's side.
- ✓ **Gameplay Rules ("Ball in Play")**
 - ❖ Active Play: The ball is considered "in play" from the moment it is intentionally tossed for service until:
 - It touches the court twice on one side.
 - It is not returned properly.
 - A point is scored or a "Let" is called.
- ✓ **"Let" (Replay)**
 - ❖ A rally is stopped and replayed (no point awarded) if:
 - The ball touches the net during service but lands correctly on the receiver's side.
 - The service is delivered when the receiving player (or pair) is not ready.
 - Play is disturbed by an external accident or interference beyond the players' control.
 - The umpire stops play for any valid reason.

8. Volleyball

The volleyball event shall be conducted only if more than four (4) teams/players are registered.

- ✓ **Service Rules:**
 - ❖ The server must serve the ball from behind the end line (restraining line) and shall not step on or cross the line until after the ball is contacted.
 - ❖ The serve may be executed using underhand or overhand technique.
 - ❖ The ball must be clearly visible to the opponents at the time of service.
 - ❖ A served ball that touches the net and lands in the opponent's court shall be considered legal and result in a point.
 - ❖ The serve for the first game shall be decided by a volley. Each subsequent game shall be served by the team that lost the previous game.
 - ❖ The serve must be received by a bump/pass only. Setting or attacking a serve is not permitted.
- ✓ **Scoring System:**
 - ❖ Rally Point Scoring System shall be followed.
 - ❖ A point shall be awarded on every rally, irrespective of which team serves.
 - ❖ A point shall be awarded to:

- ❖ The offensive team when the defensive team commits a fault or hits the ball out of bounds.
- ❖ The defensive team when the offensive team commits a fault, hits the ball out of bounds, or serves into the net.
- ❖ Final match shall be played up to 25 points.
- ❖ A team must win by a minimum margin of two (2) points.
- ✓ **Rotation Rules:**
 - ❖ For SPRINT 2026, standard rotation restrictions are relaxed.
 - ❖ Teams shall rotate clockwise each time they win the serve.
 - ❖ Switching of positions shall be allowed only among front-line players, and only after the serve.
- ✓ **Playing the Ball (Volley Rules):**
 - ❖ A team is allowed a maximum of three (3) hits to return the ball over the net.
 - ❖ A player shall not hit the ball twice consecutively. (A block is not considered a hit.)
 - ❖ The ball may be played off the net during a rally or on service.
 - ❖ A ball touching the boundary line shall be considered in.
 - ❖ A legal hit is any contact with the ball by a player's body above and including the waist, provided the ball does not visibly come to rest.
 - ❖ If two or more players contact the ball simultaneously, it shall be counted as one hit, and those players shall not participate in the next hit.
 - ❖ A player shall not block or attack a serve.
- ✓ **Faults & Violations:**
 - ❖ A point shall be awarded to the opponent if a team commits any of the following:
 - Stepping on or over the end line while serving.
 - Failure to serve the ball successfully over the net.
 - Illegal ball handling, including carrying, palming, or throwing the ball.
 - Touching the net with any part of the body while the ball is in play (except when the ball is driven into the net with such force that it causes the net to touch a player — no fault in such cases).
 - ❖ Reaching over the net, except:
 - During a legal follow-through.
 - When blocking a ball after the opponent's third hit.
 - ❖ Reaching under the net if it interferes with the ball or an opposing player.
 - ❖ Failure to serve in the correct order.
 - ❖ Blocking or spiking from a back-row position while clearly inside the 10-foot line.

9. Carrom

- ✓ **General Rules for Carrom Tournament:**
 - ❖ The Carrom event shall be conducted only if more than four (4) players or teams are registered.
- ✓ **Match Commencement:**
 - ❖ The right to break shall be decided by toss by the match official.
 - ❖ The breaker shall strike the striker from behind the baseline.
 - ❖ On the break, at least one coin must cross the centre line or be pocketed; failing which, the break shall be considered invalid.

✓ **Playing Rules:**

- ❖ Players shall take turns to strike the striker using one finger only.
- ❖ A player must first contact their own coloured coin during a strike.
- ❖ If a player successfully pockets one of their own coins, they shall continue their turn.
- ❖ If a player fails to pocket a coin, the turn shall pass to the opponent.

✓ **Queen Rules:**

- ❖ The Queen may be pocketed at any time during the match.
- ❖ The Queen must be covered by pocketing one of the player's own coins:
 - In the same turn, or
 - In the immediately subsequent turn.
- ❖ If the Queen is not covered as specified, it shall be returned to the centre of the board.

✓ **Fouls & Penalties:**

- ❖ A penalty shall be imposed for any of the following:
 - Pocketing the striker, which shall result in a penalty (generally the return of one coin to the board).
 - Hitting the opponent's coin first.
 - Pocketing the opponent's coin.
 - Pocketing the Queen without covering it as per the prescribed rule.

✓ **Winning the Game:**

- ❖ The first player/team to pocket all their assigned coins and the Queen, in accordance with the rules, shall be declared the winner.

10. Air Rifle Shooting

✓ **General Rules for Air Rifle Shooting Tournament:**

- ❖ The Air Rifle Shooting event shall be conducted only if more than four (4) players or teams are registered.

✓ **Event Structure:**

- ❖ The competition shall be conducted in two rounds, followed by final ranking, as detailed below.

✓ **Round 1 – Qualifying Round:**

- ❖ Distance: 10 meters
- ❖ Number of shots: 5 shots per participant
- ❖ Maximum score: 50 points
- ❖ Scores obtained in this round shall be used to determine qualification for the next round.

✓ **Round 2 – Winner's Round:**

- ❖ Distance: 20 meters
- ❖ Number of shots: 10 shots per participant
- ❖ Maximum score: 100 points
- ❖ Top 15 players from Round 1 shall qualify for this round.

✓ **Final Ranking & Tie-Break:**

- ❖ Final winners shall be selected from the top 15 participants competing in Round 2.
- ❖ In case two or more players score equal points, an additional tie-break round shall be conducted among the tied players.

- ❖ The participant securing the highest score in the tie-break round shall be ranked higher and shall qualify accordingly.
- ✓ **Safety Regulations:**
 - ❖ All participants must strictly adhere to the safety instructions issued by the Sports Department.
 - ❖ Failure to follow safety instructions shall result in immediate disqualification, without any argument or appeal.
 - ❖ The decision of the referee regarding safety and conduct shall be final and binding.

11. Tug of War

- ✓ **Team Composition & Weight Limits:**
 - ❖ Each team shall consist of eight (8) players, with one (1) substitute permitted.
 - ❖ The total team weight shall not exceed:
 - Men (Boys): 640 kg (8 players + 1 substitute)
 - Women (Girls): 540 kg (8 players + 1 substitute)
 - ❖ Teams shall be matched with equal numbers of players and should be reasonably balanced in strength and weight.
- ✓ **Field & Equipment:**
 - ❖ The match shall be played using a long rope with a clearly visible centre marker.
 - ❖ Two boundary lines shall be marked on the ground at equal distance from the centre line.
 - ❖ Teams shall line up on opposite sides of the rope, facing each other.
- ✓ **Playing Rules:**
 - ❖ Players must grip the rope with both hands only.
 - ❖ Wrapping the rope around the hands, arms, or body is strictly prohibited.
 - ❖ The match shall begin on the official signal (whistle or command such as "Pull").
 - ❖ On the signal, both teams shall pull the rope using coordinated effort.
 - ❖ A team shall win the round when it successfully pulls the rope such that the opponent's centre marker crosses its boundary line.
- ✓ **Fouls & Disqualifications:**
 - ❖ The following actions shall be considered fouls and may result in loss of the round or disqualification:
 - Sitting or lying down while pulling.
 - Wrapping the rope around any part of the body.
 - Jerking or pulling before the official start signal.

12. Chess

- ✓ **General Rules for Chess Tournament:**
 - ❖ The Chess tournament shall be conducted on a Knockout basis.
 - ❖ The allocation of White and Black pieces shall be decided by toss prior to the start of the game.
 - ❖ Each player shall be allotted 10 minutes' base time with an increment of 5 seconds per move.
 - ❖ Time shall be monitored using an approved chess clock.
 - ❖ An illegal move shall be corrected immediately upon detection.

- ❖ Two (2) illegal moves by a player during a game shall result in loss of the game for that player.
- ✓ **Standard Playing Rules**
 - ❖ The touch-move rule shall be strictly applicable.
 - ❖ A draw may be claimed under the following conditions:
 - Threefold repetition
 - Fifty-move rule
 - Mutual agreement between both players
 - ❖ Claims for draw must be made in accordance with standard chess regulations.
 - ❖ The tie-break method decided by the organizers shall be final and binding.
 - ❖ The decision of the referee shall be final in all matters.

13. Pickle-ball

- ✓ **General Rules for Pickle-ball Tournament:**
 - ❖ Matches shall be played in Singles format (1 vs 1).
 - ❖ The tournament shall be conducted on a knockout basis, unless otherwise notified.
- ✓ **Service Rules:**
 - ❖ The serve shall be executed underhand only.
 - ❖ At the time of contact, the paddle must strike the ball below the waist.
 - ❖ The serve must be delivered diagonally cross-court into the opponent's service court.
 - ❖ The server must keep both feet behind the baseline until the ball is struck.
 - ❖ Only one serve attempt shall be permitted, except in the case of a let serve.
 - ❖ The server shall serve:
 - From the right service court when the server's score is even.
 - From the left service court when the server's score is odd.
- ✓ **Scoring System:**
 - ❖ Only the serving player shall score points.
 - ❖ Games shall be played up to 11 points.
 - ❖ A player must win by a minimum margin of two (2) points.
 - ❖ The server shall continue serving until a fault is committed.
 - ❖ After a fault, the serve shall pass to the opponent.
- ✓ **Double-Bounce Rule**
 - ❖ After the serve, the receiver must allow the ball to bounce once before returning it.
 - ❖ The server must also allow the return to bounce once.
 - ❖ After these two bounces, players may volley or play off the bounce.
- ✓ **Non-Volley Zone (Kitchen):**
 - ❖ The non-volley zone, commonly known as the kitchen, extends 7 feet from the net on both sides.
 - ❖ Players shall not volley the ball while standing in the kitchen.
 - ❖ Stepping on or touching the kitchen line during a volley shall be considered a fault.
- ✓ **Faults:**
 - ❖ A fault shall be called if:

- The ball is hit out of bounds.
- The ball is volleyed while the player is in the kitchen.
- The ball fails to clear the net.
- The double-bounce rule is violated.
- An illegal serve is executed.
- Any rule governing service or play is violated.



Darshan
UNIVERSITY
योग: कर्मसु कौशलम्